

GREETINGS WHEN WE MEET SOMEONE

OHAYOU GOZAIMASU → Good morning (polite)

OHAYOU → Morning / Good morning (casual)

KONNICHIIWA → Hello / Good afternoon

KONBANWA → Good evening

GREETINGS WHEN LEAVING (Saying Goodbye)

OTSUKARESAMA DESHITA → Thank you for your hard work
(formal goodbye, often used at work)

OTSUKARE → Thanks / Good job (casual version)

OSAKI NI SHITSUREISHIMASU → Excuse me for leaving before
you (polite workplace phrase)

JAA MATA → See you later

OYASUMINASAI → Good night (polite)

OYASUMI → Good night (casual)

SAYOUNARA → Goodbye (formal, long-term)

THANK YOUS

DOUMO ARIGATOU GOZAIMASU → Thank you very much (formal)

ARIGATOU GOZAIMASU → Thank you (polite)

DOUMO ARIGATOU → Thanks a lot

ARIGATOU → Thanks (casual)

DOUMO → Thanks (very casual, short)

APOLOGIES

SUMIMASEN → Excuse me / I'm sorry / Thank you (depending on context)

GOMENASAI → I'm sorry (polite)

GOMEN → Sorry (casual)

PLEASE

~ KUDASAI → Please (when requesting something, e.g., “mizu kudasai” = “water please”)

ONEGAISHIMASU → Please (used when requesting a favor, service, or help)

DOUZO → Here you go / Please (when offering something)

CLASSROOM INSTRUCTIONS & EXPRESSIONS

OHAYOU GOZAIMASU → Good Morning

KONNICHIWA → Good Afternoon / Hello

MINASAN → Everyone

TATTE KUDASAI → Please Stand

INORI O SHIMASHOU → Let's pray

SUWATTE KUDASAI → Please Sit Down

HAJIMEMASHOU → Let's begin

YONDE KUDASAI → Please read

KIITE KUDASAI → Please listen

ITTE KUDASAI → Please say

KURIKAESHITE KUDASAI → Please repeat

KAITE KUDASAI → Please write

MOU ICHIDO / MOU IKKAI → One more time / Once again

OSOKUNATTE SUMIMASEN SENSEI → I am sorry I am late, teacher

SHIZUKA NI SHITE KUDASAI → Please keep quiet

WAKARIMASU KA → Do you understand?

HAI, WAKARIMASU → Yes, I understand

IIE, WAKARIMASEN → No, I don't understand

TOIRE NI ITTE MO II DESU KA → May I go to the restroom/
classroom?

SHITSUMON GA ARIMASU KA → Do you have any questions?

HAI, ARIMASU → Yes, I (we) have

IIE, ARIMASEN → No, I (we) don't have

GANBATTE KUDASAI → Good luck / Please do your best

OWARIMASHOU → Let's end

OTSUKARESAMA DESHITA → Good job today / Thank you for today

JAA MATA KONDO (SENSEI) → See you again next time (teacher)